Daein Kang

Ph.D. Student in Public Policy

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Profile

Ph.D. student at the Georgia Institute of Technology and GRO Intern at Oak Ridge National Laboratory. Research interests include energy and environmental policy, natural disasters, climate impacts, and power grid resilience.

Education

Ph.D. **Georgia Institute of Technology**, Public Policy — Atlanta, Georgia, USA
- School of Public Policy — Jan 2023 – present
- Advisor: Dr. Brian An
- Major: Energy and Environmental Policy
- Minor: Earth and Atmospheric Sciences

M.A. **Sciences Po, Paris School of International Affairs**, Advanced Global Studies (Development Practice) — Paris, France, Jan 2020 – Jan 2021

M.A. **University of St Andrews**, International Relations (Honours) — St Andrews, Scotland, Jan 2007 – Jan 2011

Experience

Oak Ridge National Laboratory, GRO Intern, Computational Earth Sciences Group — Oak Ridge, TN, USA, Aug 2026 – present, 3 months

Georgia Institute of Technology, Graduate Research Assistant — Atlanta, Georgia, USA, Jan 2023 – present, 3 years 10 months
- Climate Atlas: Impact of climate and economic conditions on mortality (2025–present)
- GROWER (Grid Resilience, Outage, Weather, & Emergency Response) Lab: Power outages and natural disasters (2024–2025)

The World Bank, Consultant, Seoul Center for Finance and Innovation — Seoul, South Korea, Jan 2021 – Jan 2024, 3 years 1 month
- Innovation policy and private sector development

United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Intern, Seoul Policy Centre — Seoul, South Korea, Jan 2021 – Jan 2022, 1 year 1 month
- Sustainable forestry practices
- SDG Partnership projects on forestry

APEC Climate Center, Project Manager, International Cooperation Department — Busan, South Korea, Jan 2016 – Jan 2020, 4 years 1 month
- Managed joint research projects, including work with FAO on climate impacts on agriculture
- Managed international knowledge-transfer programs on climate data utilization

CISM World Games Organizing Committee, Ministry of National Defence of Korea, Anglophone Cooperation Officer, International Cooperation Department — Jan 2013 – Jan 2015, 2 years 1 month

Research Interests

- Energy and environmental policy, natural disasters, climate impacts, and power grid resilience.

Publications

How national nuclear energy plans frame small modular reactors (SMRs): evidence from natural language processing of global policy documents Jan 2026
Daein Kang, John D. Kim, Moe Kyaw Thu, Brian Y. An
10.1088/1748-9326/ae8e92 (Environmental Research Letters, 21(15), 154027)

Lessons from Korea's Energy Efficiency Policies in the Industrial Sector Jan 2023
A. Aridi, K. Kim, J. Lee, N. Shin, D. Kang
documents.worldbank.org/curated/en/099906108172338225/IDU0f7ebfd9b0df990435a0940f0d7abeaf292dc (World Bank Group, Finance, Competitiveness and Innovation Global Practice)

A Collective Vision for Agriculture Climate Services in the Asia-Pacific Region Jan 2022
J. Han, I. Jang, D. Kang, M. Baek, H. Kanamaru, K. Kim
(Bulletin of the American Meteorological Society)

Suggestion of User-Centered Climate Service Framework and Development of User Interface Platform for Climate Change Adaptation Jan 2018
J. Cho, I. Jung, W. Cho, E. Lee, D. Kang, J. Lee
(Journal of Climate Change Research, Vol. 9, No. 1)

Presentations and Posters

- **Who Holds the Proof? Housing Tenure, Documentation, and Administrative Burden in Federal Disaster Assistance** (2026). Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Annual Fall Research Conference, Boston, MA, November 5, 2026. Panel: Power, Protection, and Precarity: Evaluating Interventions in Housing Stability.
- **Building Resilience through Equity: A 20-Year Analysis of FEMA Disaster Assistance and Structural Disparities** (2025). APPAM Annual Fall Research Conference, Seattle, WA, November 13, 2025. Panel: Disaster Aid, Equity, and Electoral Disruptions: Analyzing the Impact of Climate Hazards and Government Responses.

Working Papers and Research in Progress

- **Who Holds the Proof? Housing Tenure, Documentation, and Administrative Burden in Federal Disaster Assistance.** With Dr. Brian An, Georgia Tech.
- **Temperature-Related Mortality Estimates Across Climate Datasets and Statistical, Dynamical, and AI-Based Downscaling Methods** (2026). Research in progress with Moetasim Ashfaq (Oak Ridge National Laboratory). Examines the sensitivity of temperature-related mortality estimates to observational climate datasets and statistical, dynamical, and machine-learning downscaling methods.
- **Population Risk Preferences and Disaster Outcomes**
- **Grid Reliability or Resilience? Natural Disasters and Comparative Analysis in Four Southeastern US States.** With Dr. Brian An, Georgia Tech.
- **Unpacking Threshold Parameters for Declaration of Natural Disasters Due to Hurricanes**
- **Global Development for Clean Hydrogen Policies and Governance.** With Dr. Brian An (Georgia Tech), Jenny (Ahyun) Jung (Seoul National University), and Mintiben Patel (Georgia Tech).